

EXECUTIVE ESTIMATE

1. Primary estimate

The premarket regime is defensive (score -18). NQ is 29,192.50; conviction requires confirmation from volatility, semiconductors, and the largest index weights.
2. Dominant driver

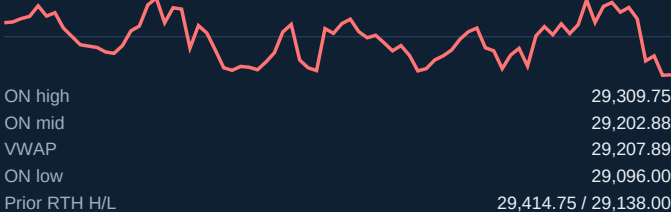
Inflation / growth is the highest-priority narrative lane. Can reprice the expected rate path and the growth premium embedded in Nasdaq-100 multiples.
3. Timing risk

The next material event is U.S. Treasury 7-Year auction at 12:00 PM CT; use the listed event-risk window.

MARKET POSTURE AND CROSS-ASSET CONFIRMATION

NQ 29,192.50 -0.66% vs prior close	REGIME Defensive score -18	VIX 15.68 -2.06% premarket	10Y YIELD N/A N/A prior day	MEGA-CAP BREADTH 38% SMH -1.08%
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NQ SESSION MAP



EVENT CLOCK AND RISK WINDOWS

12:00 PM CT	U.S. Treasury 7-Year auction
12:00 PM CT	U.S. Treasury 4-Week auction
10:00 AM CT	Access to and Use of Leave

CONDITIONAL SCENARIO MATRIX - MODEL WEIGHTS, NOT FORECAST PROBABILITIES

DOWNSIDE LIQUIDATION 38% TRIGGER Acceptance below 29,096.00 with VIX rising and semiconductors lagging. CONFIRMATION 10Y yields or the dollar rise, credit underperforms, and the largest index weights are broadly negative. INVALIDATION Rapid reclaim of 29,202.88 and session VWAP.	BALANCE / FAILED BREAK 33% TRIGGER Price remains between 29,096.00 and 29,309.75 or rejects the first break. CONFIRMATION Mixed mega-cap breadth, muted cross-asset confirmation, and repeated rotation through VWAP. INVALIDATION Two consecutive 15-minute closes outside the overnight range with confirming internals.	UPSIDE CONTINUATION 29% TRIGGER Sustained acceptance above 29,309.75 with semiconductors and mega-cap breadth confirming. CONFIRMATION NQ holds session VWAP; VIX does not expand; SMH and at least five major weights remain positive. INVALIDATION Return below 29,202.88 with volatility expanding.
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WHAT CHANGED, POSITIONING, AND NEXT DECISION POINTS

CHANGE SINCE PRIOR EDITION

No label change; new narrative: AI / semis, Energy / inflation impulse.

CFTC POSITIONING

Asset managers net +6,946; leveraged money net -59,377; weekly change asset managers -62,080, leveraged money +8,332.

NEXT DECISION POINT Inflation / growth: A second high-authority source plus confirming movement in the relevant market internals.

FEDERAL RESERVE AND GOVERNMENT EVIDENCE

Fri 9:01 AM | Bls Latest

Major Economic Indicators Latest Numbers

TOP NARRATIVE CLUSTERS

INFLATION / GROWTH | MIXED | 22 SOURCES

S&P 500, Nasdaq futures flat before PCE data, Nvidia Q2 earnings - Yahoo Finance
Can reprice the expected rate path and the growth premium embedded in Nasdaq-100 multiples.

LABOR | MIXED | 1 SOURCES

Major Economic Indicators Latest Numbers
Alters the soft-landing versus overheating balance and therefore Fed reaction expectations.

AI / SEMIS | MIXED | 72 SOURCES

Nasdaq Analysis: Two Critical Levels to Watch Around Nvidia Earnings - investingLive
Directly affects the highest-beta earnings and capital-spending complex inside NQ.

FED / RATES | CONSTRUCTIVE | 8 SOURCES

Nasdaq 100 Forecast: NDX falls as Treasury yields rebound, oil prices rise further - FOREX.com
Changes the discount-rate and liquidity path that dominates long-duration technology valuation.

EVIDENCE LEDGER - RANKED BY NQ RELEVANCE, AUTHORITY, RECENCY, AND CORROBORATION

SCORE	CLUSTER	SOURCE / INTELLIGENCE	AGE
84	Inflation / growth	Yahoo Finance: S&P 500, Nasdaq futures flat before PCE data, Nvidia Q2 earnings - Yahoo Finance	1h
81	Inflation / growth	qz.com: S&P 500, Nasdaq futures flat before PCE data, Nvidia Q2 earnings - qz.com	1h
80	Inflation / growth	thestreet.com: Stock Market Today (Aug. 26, 2026): Nasdaq futures edge lower ahead of PCE, Nvidia earnings - thestreet.com	1h
70	Labor	Bls Latest: Major Economic Indicators Latest Numbers	118h
70	Inflation / growth	Stocktwits: S&P 500, Dow, Nasdaq Futures Rangebound As Investors Await Nvidia Earnings, Key Inflation Reading — MRNA, SPCX, PSKY, OpenAI In Focus - Stocktwits	8h
68	Fed / rates	FOREX.com: Nasdaq 100 Forecast: NDX falls as Treasury yields rebound, oil prices rise further - FOREX.com	3h
67	AI / semis	investingLive: Nasdaq Analysis: Two Critical Levels to Watch Around Nvidia Earnings - investingLive	5h
67	Fed / rates	finance.biggo.com: Falling Treasury Yields Spark Tech Rebound as Nvidia Earnings Loom as Key Market Catalyst - finance.biggo.com	1h

CORPORATE CONCENTRATION AND CATALYST WATCH

No qualifying top-weight earnings event or material SEC filing was detected in the review window.

CONTRADICTIONS, BLIND SPOTS, AND SOURCE HEALTH

AI / SEMIS

High-authority reporting points in both directions; require market confirmation rather than narrative conviction.

MEGA-CAP

High-authority reporting points in both directions; require market confirmation rather than narrative conviction.

COLLECTION HEALTH

46/56 sources succeeded; 82% coverage; 11 duplicate headlines removed.
Unavailable values are withheld; no synthetic quote or event data is inserted.

ANALYST WATCHLIST, PROVENANCE, AND LIMITS

1. Inflation / growth

A second high-authority source plus confirming movement in the relevant market internals.
2. Labor

A second high-authority source plus confirming movement in the relevant market internals.
3. AI / semis

A second high-authority source plus confirming movement in the relevant market internals.

METHOD Official-source precedence; delayed public market data; authority/recency/relevance scoring; cross-source deduplication; conditional scenario logic; prior-edition change detection; source-health telemetry.

Full source URLs, timestamps, health records, report archive, JSON evidence, and methodology are retained in the browser application.